The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl, vol. 3).
. Sinha, *Raja Birbal*.
. Ibid.
. Badauni, *Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh*, trans. W.H. Lowe.
. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 3.
. Ibid.
. Ibid.
. Abu'l Fazl, *The History of Akbar*, vol. 6, trans. W.M. Thackston.
. 'I asked the date of his decease from the Old Man of Intellect: / Cheerfully replied the wise Old Man: "He is gone to Hell."'
. Sinha, *Raja Birbal*.
. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 3.
. Abu'l Fazl, *The Ain-i-Akbari*, vol. 1, trans. H. Blochmann (First published 1927; Low Price Publications, 2014).
. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 3.
. On one of his journeys back from Kashmir, Akbar said, 'It is forty years since I saw snow, and there are many men with me, born and bred in Hind, who have never seen it. If a snow-storm should come upon us in the neighbourhood of Pakhali, it would be a kind dispensation of Providence.' Nizamuddin tells the story and writes that the snowstorm Akbar had wished for did occur. See Nizamuddin Ahmad, 'Tabakat-i Akbari', in *The History of India, As Told by Its Own Historians*, trans. H.M. Elliot, vol. 5 (Trübner and Co., 1873).
It wasn't only his men but also his elephants who struggled with his travels into unfamiliar terrain. Father Xavier of the third Jesuit mission to Akbar's court provides this memorable description of an elephant negotiating its way uphill: 'Sometimes, feeling insecure on its feet, owing to the load which it carried, it supported itself with its trunk, making it serve the purpose of a staff.' See Fr. Pierre Du Jarric, *Akbar and the Jesuits: An Account of the Jesuit Missions to the Court of Akbar*, trans. C.H. Payne (First published 1926; Low Price Publications, 2008).
. Vincent A. Smith, *Akbar the Great Mogul, 1542–1605* (Clarendon Press, 1917).
. Jahangir, *The Jahangirnama: Memoirs of Jahangir, Emperor of India*, ed. and trans. W.M. Thackston (Oxford University Press with the Smithsonian Institution, 1999).
. Banarasidas, *Ardhakathanak* (A Half Story), trans. Rohini Chowdhury (Penguin Books, 2009).
. 'The Happy Sayings of His Majesty', in Abu'l Fazl, *The Ain-i-Akbari*, vol. 3.
. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 3.
. Every city and district of the empire had 'vigilant and truthful men' appointed to prevent 'forcible burning', writes Abul Fazl (*The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 3).
. Ibid.
. Jahangir, *The Jahangirnama*.
. Stephen Dale, *Babur: Timurid Prince and Mughal Emperor, 1483–1530* (Cambridge University Press, 2018). There is a wonderful example of the family's respect for elder women from Jahangir's life. Gulrukh Begum, daughter of Kamran and widow of the equally ill-fated Mirza Ibrahim, had eventually reconciled herself to Akbar's ascendancy and joined his court. She had even asked for her daughter to marry the eldest prince, Salim. Years later, when Salim ruled as Jahangir, he went to visit his mother-in-law. At the emperor's arrival, Gulrukh gave him a robe of honour. It was a complete inversion of the usual protocol but Jahangir, 'preferring the observance of the code (Tora) to the maintenance of royal dignity, did obeisance and took the robe'. See Nawab Samsam-ud-Daula Shah Nawaz Khan and Abdul Hayy, *The Maathir-ul-Umara: Biographies of the Muhammadan and Hindu Officers of the Timurid Sovereigns of India from 1500 to about 1780 AD*, trans. Henry Beveridge, revision, annotation and completion Baini Prashad, vols 1 and 2 (The Asiatic Society,